# Talk Is Cheap



## Scoring how your MP actually engages in Parliament, not just how often they speak

**Voting trackers count votes. Keyword tools find mentions. Our solution checks whether they actually answer.**

## The Problem

- 27 years of Hansard transcripts, publicly available
- Citizens still judge MPs on headlines and ads
- Mention counts reward talking, not accountability

**We measure substance, not volume.**

1. Did they answer the question?
2. Real commitment or vague rhetoric?
3. Has their position shifted?

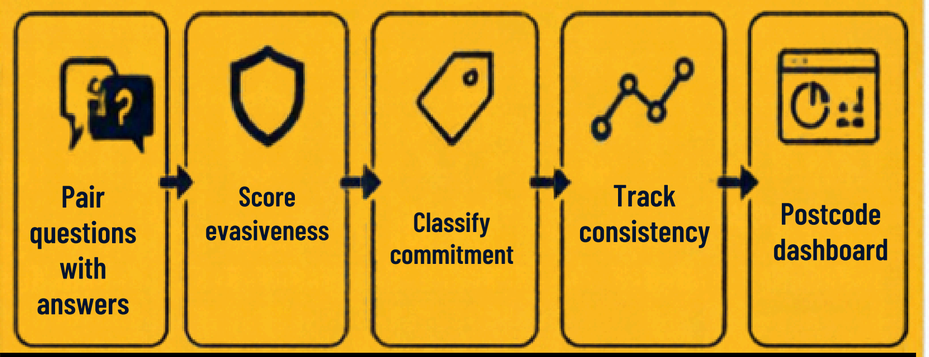
## Data

- Australian Hansard, House of Representatives
- 1998 to 2025, parsed from XML and Parquet files
- Validated electrantes, parties, Q&A pairs
- Source: Katz and Alexander, Zenodo v8

## How we measure success

- Precision, Recall, F1 on hand-labelled data
- Inter-annotator agreement (Cohen's kappa)
- Every summary traced to its source transcript
- Cross-party bias audit

## Pipeline




| Component | Classical | Neural / LLM |
|---|---|---|
| Evasiveness | TF-IDF + SVM | Semantic entailment |
| Commitment | Rule-based patterns | Fine-tuned transformer |
| Consistency | Embedding similarity | LLM stance detection |
| Summarisation | Extractive summary | RAG-grounded generation |

## Sample MP: Electorate X

**84** Mentions

Party A **0.36** vs **0.52** Party B — Dodge Index Comparison

**32%** Direct answer rate

Illustrative values. Every figure links to the original transcript.

## Who it serves

- Citizens
- Advocacy groups
- Journalists

## Ethics

- Public record only
- Measures language patterns, not intent
- Never an accusation, always linked to source


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